

National Database of State-Level Career Eligibility and Admissions Policies

Repository Maintainer Note: Annual Review Cadence

State-level admission policies operate in a highly dynamic legislative and administrative environment. To maintain data integrity across this repository, specific parameters must be verified on a strict annual cadence. The variables that change annually and require a systematic review prior to every admission cycle include the Top 20 Percentile board cutoffs, which fluctuate annually based on state board exam difficulty and grading curves, thereby altering national institute eligibility. Furthermore, state governments routinely adjust the family income limits for fee reimbursement schemes to account for inflation, while Fee Regulating Authorities (FRAs) publish revised fee structures for private unaided institutions on a yearly basis. Lastly, while vertical reservations require legislative amendments, horizontal reservations and institutional seat matrices are updated annually by state counselling authorities.

File: Odisha.md

Odisha State Entrance Exams

The Odisha Joint Entrance Examination (OJEE) Committee is the central statutory authority governing admissions to professional courses across the state. The committee directly conducts state-level entrance examinations for lateral entry programs, pharmacy, and various postgraduate technical courses¹. However, for primary undergraduate engineering and medical admissions, the state relies entirely on national-level examinations, utilizing JEE Main and NEET UG, respectively, to establish applicant merit². The OJEE Committee strictly manages the localized counselling, document verification, and seat allotment processes for these national exams. The counselling mandate covers 85% of state quota seats in government medical and dental colleges, alongside 100% of the seats in private medical and dental colleges within the state jurisdiction, while admissions to deemed universities are handled separately by the Directorate General of Health Services².

Odisha Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Odisha mandates rigorous nativity requirements to restrict access to its state quota seats. To qualify as a domicile, a candidate must establish that they are a permanent native of Odisha or the child of an All India Civil Service officer actively serving in the Odisha cadre². The administrative friction typically arises when a student originates from Odisha but completes their primary or secondary schooling in a different state. The policy accommodates this demographic smoothly, provided the student can produce an online 'Resident/Nativity Certificate' issued by an appropriate local state authority, such as a Tahsildar, validating their permanent roots¹. Conversely, candidates from outside the state are designated under the 'ZZ'

category, rendering them completely ineligible for government college counselling and restricting their admission prospects strictly to management quota seats in private institutions¹.

Odisha Reservation Structure

Odisha operates a reservation matrix that deviates significantly from the central government's schema, most notably through the total absence of an Other Backward Classes (OBC) category. All OBC candidates in Odisha are evaluated entirely within the Unreserved/General (GE) pool for state medical and engineering admissions². Vertical reservations are allocated strictly to Scheduled Tribes (ST) and Scheduled Castes (SC). The policy enforces a strict non-interchangeability rule between these categories; if ST seats remain unfilled, they roll over into the unreserved allotment rather than being offered to SC candidates². Horizontally, Odisha enforces a critical State Government Schools (SGS) quota, alongside specific set-asides for Green Card Holders and Ex-Servicemen⁴.

Reservation Category	Type	Allocation Percentage	
Scheduled Tribe (ST)	Vertical	12%	2
Scheduled Caste (SC)	Vertical	8%	2
State Government Schools (SGS)	Horizontal	15%	2
Green Card Holders (GC)	Horizontal	5%	4
Ex-Servicemen (ES)	Horizontal	3%	4
Persons with Disabilities (PwD)	Horizontal	5%	3

Odisha State Scholarships

The state utilizes targeted horizontal reservations as an indirect financial and accessibility aid, most notably through the 15% SGS quota, which significantly lowers the competitive barrier for rural students². Direct financial aid is managed through the e-Medhabruti scheme and category-specific post-matric scholarships. To claim any category or sub-category benefit, the

production of original certificates issued exclusively by the Government of Odisha is strictly enforced, effectively neutralizing any caste or income documents issued by central authorities or other states².

Odisha Board Recognition & Normalization

Significant friction occurs for students attempting to leverage the 15% SGS horizontal reservation. The administrative policy explicitly demands that both the 10th Board Examination be passed under the Board of Secondary Education (BSE) Odisha and the 12th Board Examination under the Council of Higher Secondary Education (CHSE) Odisha, exclusively from state government schools². Students who attend a state government school but sit for central board exams like CBSE or ICSE are immediately disqualified from this quota, representing a major hurdle in board recognition. For national exams, the CHSE Odisha board scores are utilized to calculate the Top 20 percentile cutoffs.

Odisha Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

Medical education costs in Odisha are highly stratified, necessitating careful financial planning. Government medical colleges operate on a highly subsidized model, charging nominal tuition fees. However, private medical colleges exact significantly higher tolls, divided between standard management quotas and highly lucrative NRI quotas. Real costs also include non-refundable processing fees for counselling and substantial annual living expenses.

Fee Component	Estimated Annual Cost (₹)	
Government College Tuition	37,950	5
Private College (Management Quota)	5,50,000 – 6,50,000	5
Private College (NRI Quota)	22,00,000 – 26,00,000	5
Hostel & Mess Fees	60,000 – 1,00,000	5
OJEE Registration Processing Fee	1,000 (One-time)	2

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most prevalent point of failure for students and parents in Odisha is the presumption of OBC reservation. Because national exams like NEET and JEE actively prompt students for OBC-NCL status, thousands of applicants assume this applies to state counselling. When they

realize Odisha does not recognize OBC status for state quotas, they discover too late that their national qualifying percentile is assessed against the General category standard (50th percentile) rather than the reserved standard (40th percentile), resulting in sudden, unexpected disqualification².

Metadata & Official Sources

- **Last Verified:** August 2026
- **Official Sources:**
 - Odisha Joint Entrance Examination (OJEE) Official Portal: <https://ojee.nic.in/>⁴
 - OJEE Information Brochure: https://odishajee.com/news_document/OJEE_information_brochure_28-01-2026_FNL_436.pdf¹

File: Uttar_Pradesh.md

Uttar Pradesh State Entrance Exams

The Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Technical University (AKTU) orchestrates the Uttar Pradesh Technical Admission Counselling (UPTAC) for undergraduate and postgraduate courses, encompassing B.Tech, B.Arch, and B.Pharm programs⁶. UPTAC does not conduct an independent entrance test; instead, it relies entirely on national-level exam scores, specifically JEE Main for engineering and NATA for architecture⁶. Conversely, for diploma and polytechnic admissions, the state conducts the Joint Entrance Examination Council Uttar Pradesh (JEECUP), which enforces a minimum age requirement of 14 years for candidates seeking admission to affiliated polytechnic institutes⁷.

Uttar Pradesh Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Uttar Pradesh employs a highly structured, dual-pathway domicile eligibility framework that often confuses applicants. A candidate automatically qualifies for the state quota if they passed their qualifying examination from an institution located geographically within Uttar Pradesh⁶. The critical edge-case occurs when a student studies outside the state but their family resides within it. In this scenario, the student remains fully eligible for the state quota, but they are strictly required to upload a domicile certificate belonging to their parents (Father or Mother only) during the online registration process; the student's own domicile certificate is legally insufficient and will be rejected⁶. Candidates who neither studied in Uttar Pradesh nor possess UP-domiciled parents are relegated to a maximum of 20% of the sanctioned seats in private affiliated institutions and are entirely excluded from government seat allotments⁶.

Uttar Pradesh Reservation Structure

While Uttar Pradesh adheres to standard vertical reservations for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, and Other Backward Classes, the state's documentation standards are exceptionally stringent. To claim OBC (Non-Creamy Layer) status, the certificate must be issued on or after

April 1 of the admission year, explicitly stating the income threshold for the preceding three continuous years⁸. Furthermore, certificates must be generated and verifiable through the UP Government's e-District portal, and the caste name on the document must precisely match the state's official gazette to survive document verification⁸.

Uttar Pradesh State Scholarships

The UP Scholarship and Fee Reimbursement Online System represents one of the most expansive financial aid networks in the country, utilizing mandatory One Time Registration (OTR) and Aadhaar-seeded Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) mechanisms¹¹. The scheme offers both Pre-Matric and Post-Matric scholarships catering to General, SC, ST, OBC, and Minority students¹¹. A unique administrative feature is the "Post-Matric Other State" provision, which legally permits UP-domiciled students pursuing studies in recognized institutions outside the state boundaries to claim financial reimbursement from the Uttar Pradesh government¹¹.

Scholarship Category	Maximum Annual Family Income Limit (₹)	
General, OBC, Minority (Post-Matric)	2,00,000	11
SC, ST (Post-Matric)	2,50,000	11
All Categories (Pre-Matric)	2,50,000	11

Uttar Pradesh Board Recognition & Normalization

The UP Board of High School and Intermediate Education enforces a passing criterion requiring students to score a minimum of 33% (Grade D or above) individually in both theory and practical examinations¹². From a normalization perspective, the UP Board's top 20 percentile cutoff for JoSAA eligibility often sits lower than the CBSE average, providing a mathematical advantage to state board students competing for NIT and IIIT admissions¹⁴. For instance, the 2025 General category top 20 percentile cutoff for the UP Board was recorded at 373/500, significantly lower than the CBSE requirement¹⁵.

Uttar Pradesh Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

While UPTAC dictates the admission and central fee framework, the actual financial burden on economically weaker students is heavily subsidized post-admission via the state scholarship portal. However, a significant cost realization gap exists for students in private institutions. The state scholarship exclusively reimburses the government-approved tuition rate. Consequently, students are left entirely liable for unregulated institutional development fees, mandatory transportation charges, and hidden hostel costs that private colleges levy to maximize

revenue¹¹.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most frequent error leading to immediate seat cancellation during physical reporting is the submission of a student's own domicile certificate when they completed their 12th grade outside the state⁶. The information brochure explicitly requires the parent's domicile certificate (issued by a Tehsildar or SDM) to prove residency if the schooling occurred inter-state, a nuance that thousands of applicants overlook annually⁶. Additionally, submitting an OBC-NCL certificate issued prior to April 1 of the admission year results in automatic conversion to the General category.

Metadata & Official Sources

- **Last Verified:** August 2026
- **Official Sources:**
 - UPTAC Admissions Portal: <https://uptac.admissions.nic.in/>⁶
 - UP Scholarship Portal: <https://scholarship.up.gov.in/>¹¹
 - e-District UP Portal: <https://edistrict.up.gov.in/>¹⁰

File: Bihar.md

Bihar State Entrance Exams

The Bihar Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board (BCECEB) serves as the centralized authority for professional admissions across the state¹⁷. Medical and dental admissions are strictly governed under the Under Graduate Medical Admission Counselling (UGMAC) framework, which processes state rankings based solely on NEET UG scores¹⁸. Similarly, engineering admissions utilize JEE Main scores, while the Diploma Certificate Entrance Competitive Examination (DCECE) is an independent state exam conducted for polytechnic and diploma admissions²⁰.

Bihar Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

To claim the highly competitive 85% state quota for UGMAC or state engineering counselling, a candidate must legally qualify as a permanent resident of Bihar¹⁹. Unlike states that offer a flexible pathway where continuous local schooling automatically grants domicile, Bihar maintains a rigid documentation requirement. If a student originates from Bihar but completes their critical secondary education in coaching hubs like Kota or Delhi, they cannot rely on their school leaving certificates. They must proactively secure a formal residential certificate from their home district's Circle Officer or Sub-Divisional Magistrate in Bihar prior to participating in BCECEB counselling¹⁹. Students originating from other states are strictly disqualified from accessing Bihar's state quota seats¹⁹.

Bihar Reservation Structure

Bihar's reservation matrix is highly fragmented, reflecting a complex legislative effort to address granular demographic equity across the state. The state replaces a monolithic OBC category with distinct backward classes, significantly altering the competitive landscape for applicants. The vertical reservation structure includes a 5% horizontal overlap for Persons with Benchmark Disabilities (PwD)²¹.

Category	Reservation Percentage	
Extremely Backward Class (EBC)	18%	21
Scheduled Caste (SC)	16%	21
Backward Class (BC)	12%	21
Economically Weaker Section (EWS)	10%	21
Reserved Category Girls (RCG)	3%	21
Scheduled Tribe (ST)	1%	21

Bihar State Scholarships

The Bihar Post Matric Scholarship (PMS) is the primary vehicle for state financial aid, administered exclusively via the PMS Online portal. The scheme caters specifically to SC, ST, BC, and EBC students, implementing a firm income ceiling of ₹3,00,000 annually across all categories²². Financial assistance scales progressively based on the complexity and cost of the course undertaken. The application process is highly rigid; defects in applications trigger a limited window for correction via a dedicated 'Defected Login' portal, after which uncorrected applications are permanently rejected²⁴.

Course Level	Maximum Financial Assistance (₹)	
Intermediate	2,000	23

Graduation / Post Graduation	5,000	23
Polytechnic / Diploma	10,000	23
Professional Courses	15,000	23

Bihar Board Recognition & Normalization

The Bihar School Examination Board (BSEB) operates with a notoriously stringent grading curve, which ironically creates a massive systemic advantage for its students under the national Top 20 Percentile rule. For JEE Main (JoSAA) eligibility, the top 20 percentile cutoff for the BSEB General category is historically low—registering at 347/500 in 2024 and 345/500 in 2025¹⁴. Consequently, a Bihar board student scoring just 69% in their 12th board exams meets the percentile threshold for IITs and NITs, whereas a CBSE student requires a score nearing 84% to achieve the same eligibility¹⁵.

Bihar Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

Government medical and engineering institutions in Bihar feature highly subsidized tuition fees, making them highly sought after. Conversely, private medical colleges command management and NRI quota fees that are disconnected from the state's median economic realities. Furthermore, scholarship reimbursements are strictly capped at the government-approved fee schedule. Private institutions frequently levy exorbitant, non-refundable miscellaneous fees, leaving marginalized students to cover a significant financial delta out-of-pocket²³.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The primary cause of scholarship rejection and administrative failure in Bihar is the misunderstanding of Aadhaar-Bank Account Seeding via the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)²⁴. Thousands of students provide a valid bank account number on the portal but fail to realize that Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) requires the Aadhaar to be biologically mapped to the account at the banking backend; without this NPCI mapping, the scholarship application cannot be finalized²⁵. Additionally, during UGMAC counselling, students frequently confuse the BC and EBC categories during registration, which results in immediate disqualification and forfeiture of seat allotment during physical document verification²¹.

Metadata & Official Sources

- **Last Verified:** August 2026
- **Official Sources:**
 - BCECEB Official Portal: <https://bceceboard.bihar.gov.in/>¹⁷
 - Bihar Post Matric Scholarship Portal: <https://pmsonline.bihar.gov.in/>²⁵

File: Maharashtra.md

Maharashtra State Entrance Exams

The State Common Entrance Test Cell, Maharashtra, executes a vast array of entrance examinations, most notably the MHT CET for engineering, pharmacy, and agriculture courses²⁶. The exam evaluates students on a PCM or PCB syllabus derived directly from the state board curriculum²⁶. Conducted across multiple computer-based shifts, the CET Cell utilizes a percentile normalization method to ensure equitable scoring²⁶. The Cell also conducts specific professional exams such as the MAH-LLB for law and the MAH-M.HMCT CET for hotel management²⁸. Medical admissions rely exclusively on NEET UG scores but are counselled through the centralized apparatus of the State CET Cell.

Maharashtra Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Maharashtra legislates the most complex and nuanced domicile categorization framework in the country, fragmenting state candidates into five distinct types (A through E) to handle residency friction comprehensively³⁰.

- **Type A:** The candidate passed SSC (10th) and HSC (12th) from Maharashtra AND is either domiciled or born in the state³⁰.
- **Type B:** The candidate does not meet Type A criteria, but their mother or father holds a valid Maharashtra domicile certificate³⁰.
- **Type C:** The candidate's mother or father is a Government of India employee who has been posted and reported to duty in Maharashtra prior to the application deadline³⁰.
- **Type D:** The candidate's mother or father is a current or retired employee of the Government of Maharashtra³⁰.
- **Type E:** Dedicated to candidates residing in the disputed Maharashtra-Karnataka border area who passed their qualifying exams in a Marathi medium institution³⁰. Outside Maharashtra State (OMS) candidates are permitted to write the MHT CET and apply, but they are evaluated entirely as General category students and compete strictly for All India Seats²⁶.

Maharashtra Reservation Structure

Reservations in Maharashtra are strictly fenced, accessible only to candidates who establish a recognized Maharashtra State Candidature²⁶. The state enforces unparalleled documentary rigor. A candidate claiming SC, ST, OBC, VJ/DT-NT, or SBC status must produce a standard Caste Certificate and a Non-Creamy Layer Certificate where applicable. Crucially, they must also produce a Caste Validity Certificate issued by a dedicated state scrutiny committee to authenticate their claim²⁶.

Maharashtra State Scholarships

The MahaDBT portal centralizes the administration of all state financial aid. A flagship initiative

is the Rajarshi Chhatrapati Shahu Maharaj Shikshan Shulkh Shishyavrutti Yojna (EBC), which reimburses between 50% to 100% of tuition fees for students with an annual family income below ₹8,00,000, provided they secure their admission exclusively through the Centralized Admission Process (CAP)³². The state also runs dedicated schemes for religious and linguistic minority communities³⁰.

Maharashtra Board Recognition & Normalization

To achieve eligibility for CAP engineering admissions, candidates must secure an aggregate of 45% (General) or 40% (Reserved) in Physics, Mathematics, and one optional subject (Chemistry, Biotechnology, or Biology) in their HSC board exams²⁶. From a national normalization perspective, the Top 20 Percentile cutoff for the Maharashtra State Board of Secondary and Higher Secondary Education for JEE Main sits at an accessible 361/500 for the General category (2025 data), ensuring state students remain competitive for JoSAA counseling¹⁵.

Maharashtra Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

The financial landscape of unaided private professional institutions is strictly governed by the Fees Regulating Authority (FRA) under the Maharashtra Unaided Private Professional Educational Institutions (Regulation of Admissions and Fees) Act, 2015³³. The FRA defines exact, bifurcated fee structures comprising a base 'Tuition Fee' and a capped 'Development Fee'³⁵. Institutions are legally mandated to display the exact FRA-approved course-wise fees on their official websites and notice boards in both English and Marathi³⁵. Charging capitation fees or demanding amounts exceeding the FRA notification triggers severe penal consequences under the 2015 Act³⁴.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most catastrophic administrative error Maharashtra students make is applying under a reserved category without possessing a finalized Caste Validity Certificate at the time of counselling²⁶. Unlike other states where a basic caste certificate issued by a Tahsildar suffices for provisional admission, Maharashtra's legal scrutiny is absolute. If a student is allotted a reserved seat but fails to produce the validity certificate during physical reporting, the seat is immediately and irreversibly cancelled, and the student is forcibly shifted to the Open category for all subsequent rounds, often losing a year of academic progress²⁶.

Metadata & Official Sources

- **Last Verified:** August 2026
- **Official Sources:**
 - State CET Cell Official Portal: <https://cetcell.mahacet.org/>²⁷
 - Fees Regulating Authority (FRA): <https://mahafra.org/>³⁶
 - MahaDBT Scholarship Portal: <https://www.mahadbt.maharashtra.gov.in/>³²

File: West_Bengal.md

West Bengal State Entrance Exams

The West Bengal Joint Entrance Examinations Board (WBJEEB) functions as the state's central testing authority, conducting the WBJEE for undergraduate engineering, technology, and pharmacy courses³⁷. WBJEE remains distinctive nationally by retaining a traditional pen-and-paper OMR format across multiple testing centers. Furthermore, the board conducts specialized exams such as JELET, which facilitates diploma holders seeking lateral entry directly into the second year of B.Tech programs³⁸.

West Bengal Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

West Bengal has engineered a highly specific, proforma-based documentary system to address domicile nuances, deliberately separating the physical residency of the student from the permanent residency of the parents³⁹.

- **Proforma A1:** Designed for students who have resided in West Bengal continuously for at least 10 years as of December 31 of the preceding year. This document must be physically signed by a designated executive government official (such as a BDO, SDO, or District Magistrate) holding jurisdiction over the candidate's residence³⁹.
- **Proforma A2:** Serves students meeting the exact same 10-year residency criteria, but simplifies the friction by allowing certification directly by the Head of the Institution where the candidate completed or is completing their 12th grade³⁹.
- **Proforma B:** Effectively resolves the friction for students who grew up or studied entirely outside the state. If the candidate does not reside in West Bengal, but their parents are permanent residents maintaining a permanent address in the state, they utilize Proforma B, which must be certified by a competent government official³⁸.

West Bengal Reservation Structure

Reservation benefits in West Bengal are fiercely guarded and restricted entirely to candidates possessing verified West Bengal domicile³⁷. The state utilizes standard Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) categories, but critically splits the Other Backward Classes (OBC) category into OBC-A (More Backward) and OBC-B (Backward) to ensure equitable distribution among minority and backward demographics. Notably, presenting a valid category certificate automatically bypasses the need for a separate domicile certificate during document verification, streamlining the process³⁷.

West Bengal State Scholarships

The Government of West Bengal operates two flagship scholarship portals that dictate higher education financing. The Swami Vivekananda Merit-cum-Means Scholarship (SVMCM) provides high-value financial support for meritorious students across various disciplines⁴¹. Conversely, the OASIS Scholarship portal operates as a dedicated financial aid mechanism exclusively for

SC, ST, and OBC students⁴². OASIS imposes rigorous income ceilings and utilizes Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) to disburse both tuition grants and monthly maintenance allowances, with higher payouts allocated to hostellers⁴².

OASIS Scholarship Category	Annual Family Income Limit (₹)	
Scheduled Caste (SC)	2,50,000	42
Scheduled Tribe (ST)	2,50,000	42
Other Backward Classes (OBC)	1,00,000	42

West Bengal Board Recognition & Normalization

The West Bengal Council of Higher Secondary Education (WBCHSE) maintains robust national recognition, ensuring smooth equivalency across central testing agencies⁴⁴. The Top 20 percentile cutoff for WBCHSE in 2025 was recorded at 357/500 for the General category, making it a relatively advantageous board for students aiming to meet JoSAA qualifications compared to the higher thresholds demanded by central boards¹⁵.

West Bengal Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

The state's higher education ecosystem is anchored by state-aided universities, such as Jadavpur University, which offer elite engineering degrees at remarkably nominal costs, effectively functioning as accessible public goods³⁹. Private engineering colleges operate under a regulated tuition structure; however, hidden costs frequently manifest in the form of mandatory, overpriced hostel fees or non-refundable infrastructure development charges that bypass standard regulatory oversight.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most frequent point of absolute failure during WBJEE document verification is submitting a Proforma A1 or Proforma B domicile certificate signed by an elected representative, such as an MLA, MP, Panchayat member, or Municipal Councillor³⁷. The WBJEEB policy explicitly and categorically rejects these signatures; the document must be signed strictly by an executive government official (such as a Deputy Director, Magistrate, or Commissioner). Countless students lose their state rank advantages annually by submitting politically endorsed, rather than executively certified, proformas³⁹.

Metadata & Official Sources

- **Last Verified:** August 2026

- **Official Sources:**

- WBJEEB Official Portal: <https://wbjeeb.in/>³⁸
- SVMCM Scholarship Portal: <https://svmcm.wb.gov.in/>⁴¹
- OASIS Scholarship Portal: <https://oasis.gov.in/>⁴⁵

File: Tamil_Nadu.md

Tamil Nadu State Entrance Exams

Tamil Nadu represents a unique and highly debated paradigm in Indian admissions policy: the state legally abolished entrance exams for undergraduate engineering. Consequently, the Tamil Nadu Engineering Admissions (TNEA) process generates merit lists entirely based on raw Class 12 board marks achieved in Mathematics, Physics, and Chemistry, scaled to a maximum of 200⁴⁷. While medical admissions technically conform to the national NEET UG mandate, the state legislative assembly routinely contests this framework, attempting to revert to a board-mark-based medical admission system.

Tamil Nadu Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Tamil Nadu's domicile policy exhibits a heavy systemic bias towards students who completed their foundational schooling within the state's borders. Candidates who have studied continuously from Standard VIII through XII in Tamil Nadu are automatically classified as state candidates, requiring no further documentation or Nativity Certificate. However, native Tamil Nadu students who completed any fraction of their VIII to XII education outside the state face immediate friction; they must produce a formal Nativity Certificate issued by a competent Tamil Nadu revenue authority to participate in state quotas.

Tamil Nadu Reservation Structure

Tamil Nadu enforces a unique 69% vertical reservation matrix, which is legally protected under the 9th Schedule of the Indian Constitution, shielding it from standard judicial review⁴⁷. Furthermore, the state provides a transformative 7.5% horizontal reservation specifically ring-fenced for students who studied continuously in Tamil Nadu State Government Schools from Class VI to XII⁴⁷.

Reservation Category	Allocation Percentage	
Backward Classes (BC)	26.5%	47
Most Backward Classes (MBC)	20%	47

Scheduled Castes (SC)	15%	47
Backward Class Muslims (BCM)	3.5%	47
SC Arunthathiyars (SCA)	3%	47
Scheduled Tribes (ST)	1%	47

Tamil Nadu State Scholarships

Financial aid in Tamil Nadu is deeply intertwined with broader social welfare and gender equity schemes. The state assumes the complete financial burden—including tuition, hostel, and counselling fees—for all students admitted under the 7.5% Government School Quota⁴⁷. Additionally, the state operates direct monthly cash transfer schemes to incentivize higher education: the *Pudhumai Penn* scheme for girls and the newly introduced *Tamizh Pudhalvan* scheme for boys. Eligible students who completed their schooling (6th to 12th) in state government schools receive a direct bank transfer of ₹1,000 every month to support their degree, engineering, or diploma studies, drastically reducing dropout rates due to incidental expenses⁴⁸.

Tamil Nadu Board Recognition & Normalization

Because TNEA utilizes raw board marks rather than percentile normalization across different boards, massive friction exists between the Tamil Nadu State Board (TNSB) and the CBSE. Historically, the TNSB grading structure allows for a disproportionately higher volume of perfect scores in core subjects. This effectively crowds out meritorious CBSE students from securing seats in top-tier institutions, such as the Anna University CEG Campus, during the general counselling rounds, forcing them to rely on national exams for premier institutes.

Tamil Nadu Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

The Tamil Nadu Educational Institutions (Prohibition of Collection of Capitation Fee) Act, 1992, strictly prohibits the levying of capitation fees in any form⁴⁹. Government and government-aided colleges charge highly subsidized tuition, ensuring broad access. However, in private affiliated colleges, management quota fees remain substantially higher. Despite legislative prohibitions and periodic inspections, hidden costs frequently surface during admission as arbitrary "skill development," "transportation," or "infrastructure" fees that evade regulatory caps.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most common error leading to the loss of state reservation benefits involves students native to border districts (such as the Kanyakumari/Kerala border or the Cuddalore/Puducherry

border). These students frequently cross state lines daily to attend better-equipped schools in neighboring territories. When it comes time for TNEA counselling, they fail to realize that this out-of-state schooling revokes their automatic domicile status. Failing to apply for a Nativity Certificate well in advance results in these students being assessed as open-category, out-of-state candidates, permanently locking them out of the 69% reservation blocks.

Metadata & Official Sources

- **Last Verified:** August 2026
- **Official Sources:**
 - TNEA Official Portal: <https://www.tneaonline.org/>⁴⁷
 - Directorate of Collegiate Education (Tamizh Pudhalvan): <https://tndce.tn.gov.in/>⁴⁸

File: Karnataka.md

Karnataka State Entrance Exams

The Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA) is the central body responsible for conducting the Karnataka Common Entrance Test (KCET), dictating admissions to Engineering, Farm Science, Veterinary, and Pharmacy programs⁵¹. While medical admissions technically rely on NEET UG scores, the entire counselling and allotment process is routed through the KEA portal. Additionally, the Consortium of Medical, Engineering and Dental Colleges of Karnataka (COMEDK) operates as a parallel, heavily utilized entrance channel, catering primarily to the management and open seats within private engineering colleges.

Karnataka Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Karnataka employs an exhaustive alphabetical clause system (spanning Clauses A through O) to determine strict eligibility for government seats⁵¹. The most utilized pathway is Clause A, which mandates that the candidate must have studied in recognized educational institutions within Karnataka for a minimum period of seven academic years⁵¹. If a student grew up and studied outside the state, they face immense friction but can claim eligibility under Clause B, provided they can prove that either of their parents studied in Karnataka for a minimum of seven years. This policy effectively ties domicile legitimacy to educational tenure rather than mere residential property ownership or birth certificates.

Karnataka Reservation Structure

Karnataka's reservation matrix features standard categories (1, 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, SC, ST) alongside heavy horizontal reservations, including 15% for Rural Candidates and 5% for Kannada Medium Candidates—both of which require 10 years of specific, documented education to claim⁵¹. However, the most profound structural feature is the **Article 371(J) Kalyana Karnataka (Hyderabad-Karnataka) Quota**⁵¹. This constitutional provision protects the educational and employment rights of students from 7 historically underdeveloped districts (Bidar, Kalaburagi, Yadgir, Raichur, Koppal, Ballari, and Vijayanagara)⁵³.

371(J) Regional Allotment Scope	Seat Share Percentage	
Institutions located <i>within</i> the 7 HK districts	70% of available seats	51
Institutions located <i>outside</i> the HK districts	8% of available seats	51

Karnataka State Scholarships

The State Scholarship Portal (SSP) functions as the central nervous system for all post-matric scholarships, fee reimbursements (including ePASS), and minority aids. To process claims and prevent fraud, the SSP integrates heavily with the state's Kutumba (family ID) database, making Aadhaar mapping and biometric verification mandatory for the disbursement of funds.

Karnataka Board Recognition & Normalization

The Karnataka School Examination and Assessment Board (KSEAB) / PU Board maintains standard national recognition. However, the KEA implements a unique normalization formula during KCET engineering rank generation: the final rank is calculated by taking a 50:50 weightage of the student's KCET score and their 2nd PUC (12th grade) board marks in Physics, Chemistry, and Mathematics. This structural design heavily penalizes students who focus purely on competitive entrance exams while neglecting their state board performance.

Karnataka Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

The Karnataka Educational Institutions (Prohibition of Capitation Fee) Act, 1984, forms the legal basis for fee regulation in the state⁵⁵. A state-appointed Fee Regulatory Committee is tasked with determining the tuition structure for government seats in private unaided colleges. However, institutions frequently circumvent this legislative intent by charging excessive, unregulated "miscellaneous," "skill-development," or "university" fees ranging from ₹20,000 to ₹50,000 during the physical reporting stage, creating unexpected financial burdens for families⁵⁷.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The greatest friction point and source of lost opportunity in Karnataka admissions is the mismanagement of the 371(J) Kalyana Karnataka quota. Eligible students frequently assume that their standard domicile certificate, or simply being born in one of the 7 districts, automatically grants them HK status in the KEA portal⁵³. It does not. To claim this massive rank advantage, students must proactively secure a highly specific "Local Cadre Eligibility Certificate" from the Assistant Commissioner or Tahsildar of their revenue sub-division prior to

document verification⁵³. Failure to produce this exact document forfeits the constitutional reservation, forcing students who could have secured a premier college at a 30,000 rank to compete in the general pool where the cutoff is 10,000⁵³.

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File: Rajasthan.md

Rajasthan State Entrance Exams

The Rajasthan Engineering Admission Process (REAP) manages undergraduate B.Tech and B.Arch admissions across the state. Distinctively, REAP does not conduct an independent state-level engineering entrance examination. Instead, it generates merit lists primarily based on JEE Main scores, cascading down to utilize Class 12 board marks only if institutional seats remain vacant after the primary rounds⁵⁸. State medical admissions strictly utilize NEET UG rankings.

Rajasthan Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Domicile eligibility in Rajasthan is fundamentally anchored to the permanent residency of the candidate's parents. A valid Mool Niwas Praman Patra (Domicile Certificate) issued by the Government of Rajasthan is mandatory for claiming the lucrative 85% state quota for both engineering and medical seats⁵⁸.

Rajasthan Reservation Structure

Rajasthan follows standard vertical quotas for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Other Backward Classes, and Economically Weaker Sections. Uniquely, the state specifically recognizes and reserves seats for the Most Backward Classes (MBC), ensuring targeted demographic representation that differs slightly from central government categories.

Rajasthan State Scholarships

Rajasthan provides substantial targeted welfare through its Higher Education portal, focusing on both tuition relief and physical mobility⁶⁰.

1. **CM Higher Education Scholarship:** This scheme provides direct financial assistance to regular college students (excluding SC/ST students, who are covered by separate social welfare departments) whose annual family income is below ₹2.5 Lakhs⁵⁹. Candidates must be Rajasthan domiciled and have scored above 60% in their 12th board exams⁵⁸.
2. **Devnarayan Girls Scooty Scheme & Kali Bai Bheel Scheme:** These are innovative physical mobility aids that distribute free scooters to meritorious girls from specific backward communities, directly reducing the friction of commuting to higher education

centers and empowering female enrollment⁵⁹.

Rajasthan Board Recognition & Normalization

The Board of Secondary Education Rajasthan (RBSE) operates with grading standards that result in exceptionally high cutoffs for national eligibility. In 2025, the RBSE Top 20 Percentile cutoff for JEE Main (JoSAA eligibility) was 436/500 for the General category, marking it as one of the highest requirements in the country¹⁵. Consequently, RBSE students who score moderately well (e.g., 80% or 400/500) fail to meet the Top 20 percentile criterion entirely and must rely on clearing the flat 75% national rule to qualify for admission to NITs and IITs¹⁵.

Rajasthan Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

REAP operates a targeted Tuition Fee Waiver Scheme (TFWS) for economically weaker students (defined as having a family income below ₹8 Lakhs), effectively waiving tuition fees for 5% of supernumerary seats in participating engineering colleges. Outside of this scheme, private institutional fees remain high. Furthermore, the living costs in massive educational hubs like Kota add an unignorable, massive financial burden on families that is rarely factored into official fee structures.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most catastrophic error in Rajasthan admissions is falling into the "Kota Trap." Annually, tens of thousands of students from outside Rajasthan relocate to coaching hubs like Kota for 2 to 3 years to prepare intensively for JEE and NEET⁵⁹. Many parents mistakenly operate under the assumption that continuous schooling in Rajasthan for this duration automatically fulfills the state domicile requirement. It does not. Unless the parents possess permanent residency in Rajasthan (Mool Niwas), the student cannot claim the 85% state quota for NEET or REAP, a realization that completely alters their admission strategy at the last minute.

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File: Madhya_Pradesh.md

Madhya Pradesh State Entrance Exams

The Directorate of Technical Education (DTE), Madhya Pradesh, is responsible for conducting centralized counselling for engineering (B.Tech) admissions. Similar to the model in Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh does not administer a separate state-level engineering exam, relying entirely on JEE Main scores to generate merit lists. State medical counselling operates via the Department of Medical Education using NEET UG ranks.

Madhya Pradesh Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

To claim state quotas and access premier state scholarships, students must present a valid MP Domicile Certificate (Mool Niwas Praman Patra)⁶². Eligibility for this certificate is established either through birth within the state, extended continuous residence, or parental property holding and employment in the state government⁶².

Madhya Pradesh Reservation Structure

Madhya Pradesh allocates seats across Unreserved, Scheduled Caste, Scheduled Tribe, and Other Backward Classes categories. The state maintains highly specific horizontal quotas, usually reserving around 30% of seats for women, alongside dedicated spaces for dependents of freedom fighters and defense personnel.

Madhya Pradesh State Scholarships

Madhya Pradesh's **Mukhyamantri Medhavi Vidyarthi Yojana (MMVY)** stands as arguably the most aggressive state-sponsored fee intervention in the country⁶². For eligible students, the state government completely assumes the financial burden, covering 100% of the tuition fees for graduation, engineering, or medical studies across both government and private institutions.

- **Financial Eligibility:** MP domicile with an annual family income below ₹8,00,000⁶².
- **Academic Bar:** The student must have scored 70% or more in the MP Board 12th exam, or 85% or more in the CBSE/ICSE 12th exam⁶².
- **Engineering Constraint:** Crucially, the student must hold a JEE Main rank under 1,50,000⁶².

Madhya Pradesh Board Recognition & Normalization

The MP Board of Secondary Education aligns its grading curve relatively closely with national standards. For JEE Main (JoSAA) eligibility, the Top 20 percentile cutoff for the MP Board generally hovers around 409/500 (81.8%) for the General category, placing it slightly below the CBSE threshold and providing a fair normalization balance¹⁵.

Madhya Pradesh Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

Because the MMVY covers 100% of the tuition fee for eligible students admitted to both government and private institutions, the visible cost of education drops to zero for thousands of meritorious students⁶². However, the hidden costs manifest aggressively in non-tuition variables. Private colleges routinely inflate hostel charges, mandatory bus fees, and caution money, which are explicitly not covered by the state's DBT transfer and must be borne entirely by the student.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most common friction point in Madhya Pradesh involves a misunderstanding of the MMVY engineering clause. Many students assume that merely scoring 85% in their CBSE board exams

and gaining admission to a private engineering college via management quota guarantees the MMVY tuition waiver⁶². However, they completely overlook the mandate that their JEE Main rank *must* fall within the 1,50,000 threshold. Students with a rank of 1,60,000 who accept a private seat expecting full government reimbursement discover during the scholarship application phase that they are completely liable for the full tuition fee, often leading to forced dropouts⁶².

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File: Andhra_Pradesh.md

Andhra Pradesh State Entrance Exams

The Andhra Pradesh State Council of Higher Education (APSCHE) conducts the AP EAPCET (Engineering, Agriculture, and Pharmacy Common Entrance Test)⁶³. This highly competitive exam is mandatory for securing state government seats and private convener seats. State medical admissions adhere to the national NEET UG parameters but are counselled locally.

Andhra Pradesh Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Stemming from the constitutional protections of Article 371(D), Andhra Pradesh relies on a complex "Local vs. Non-Local" framework rather than standard domicile certificates⁶⁴. The state is divided into two primary university jurisdictional areas:

1. **Andhra University (AU) Area:** Covering the coastal districts.
2. **Sri Venkateswara University (SVU) Area:** Covering the Rayalaseema districts⁶⁴. A student's local status is determined by geography: specifically, where they studied for the majority of the four consecutive academic years ending with their qualifying exam (Inter/12th). 85% of seats in institutions located in a university area are reserved exclusively for local candidates of that specific area, while the remaining 15% are unreserved (open to AU, SVU, and Non-Local candidates alike)⁶⁴.

Andhra Pradesh Reservation Structure

Andhra Pradesh divides the standard OBC category into five distinct sub-groups to manage demographic equity more precisely: BC-A, BC-B, BC-C, BC-D, and BC-E. Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe quotas are applied vertically. The EWS quota is applied as a supernumerary addition where sanctioned by regulatory bodies.

Andhra Pradesh State Scholarships

The **Jagananna Vidya Deevena** scheme is a transformative welfare program providing total fee reimbursement for students pursuing higher education, directly crediting the amount to the

mother's bank account to ensure funds are utilized for education⁶⁵.

- **Income Limit:** Annual family income up to ₹2,50,000⁶⁶.
- **Scope:** Covers full tuition fees for B.Tech, Pharmacy, MBA, MCA, and other professional degrees⁶⁶. An allied scheme, *Jagananna Vasathi Deevena*, covers boarding and lodging expenses, severely reducing the financial friction of higher education⁶⁶.

Andhra Pradesh Board Recognition & Normalization

The Board of Intermediate Education, Andhra Pradesh (BIEAP) exhibits an exceptionally high scoring distribution, which creates a normalization disadvantage on a national scale. In the JoSAA Top 20 Percentile cutoffs for JEE Main, the AP Board frequently holds the highest requirement in the country. In 2025, the General category cutoff was an immense 475/500 (95%)¹⁵. Consequently, an AP board student scoring an otherwise excellent 93% fails to qualify via the percentile route and must rely on the flat 75% eligibility rule to secure an IIT or NIT seat¹⁵.

Andhra Pradesh Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

Tuition fees across private and unaided colleges are heavily capped and regulated by the AP Higher Education Regulatory and Monitoring Commission (APHERMC)⁶³. Because the Vidya Deevena scheme reimburses the exact APHERMC-mandated fee to the mother's account⁶⁶, institutions are theoretically barred from demanding excess tuition. However, autonomous colleges often exploit loopholes by levying separate, non-regulated infrastructure or accreditation charges.

The Single Most Common Mistake

The most severe mistake occurs when a student from a rural border district relocates to an educational hub like Vijayawada or Visakhapatnam for their crucial 9th to 12th-grade years to access better coaching. By shifting university areas, they inadvertently change their legal local status under Article 371(D). An SVU-origin student who completes their final four years in an AU area legally becomes an AU Local, completely losing their 85% reservation in premier SVU institutions (like SVU Tirupati or JNTU Anantapur) and forcing them to compete in the hyper-competitive 15% open pool when trying to return home for college.

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File: Telangana.md

Telangana State Entrance Exams

The Telangana State Council of Higher Education (TSCHE) conducts the TG EAPCET (formerly known as TS EAMCET) for entry into Engineering, Agriculture, and Pharmacy programs⁶⁷.

Medical seats are governed by the Kaloji Narayana Rao University of Health Sciences (KNRUHS), strictly utilizing NEET UG scores for merit generation.

Telangana Domicile Rules & Residency Friction

Sharing the historical legislative DNA of Andhra Pradesh, Telangana operates under the Article 371(D) framework. The entire state of Telangana primarily falls under the **Osmania University (OU) Local Area**⁶⁷. A student legally qualifies as a local candidate if they studied in the OU area for at least four consecutive years ending with the qualifying examination. 85% of institutional seats are reserved exclusively for OU local candidates⁶⁷. Non-local candidates (which includes students originating from Andhra Pradesh) can only compete for the 15% unreserved seats.

Telangana Reservation Structure

Telangana mirrors the backward class fragmentation seen in AP, utilizing BC-A, BC-B, BC-C, BC-D, and BC-E. The BC-E category is particularly significant as it typically caters to socially and educationally backward Muslim demographics, ensuring targeted representation.

Telangana State Scholarships

The **Telangana ePASS** (Electronic Payment and Application System of Scholarships) manages Post-Matric Scholarships and full fee reimbursements with extreme technological rigor⁶⁹. The system utilizes mandatory biometric Aadhaar authentication and disburses funds strictly to Aadhaar-seeded nationalized or postal bank accounts⁶⁹. Income limits dictate eligibility, and verification is tied dynamically to the state's broader welfare and land databases, minimizing fraudulent claims⁶⁹.

Telangana Board Recognition & Normalization

The Telangana State Board of Intermediate Education (TSBIE) is the primary recognized board. Historically, the TG EAPCET assigned a 25% weightage to intermediate board marks for calculating the final engineering rank. However, policy reviews periodically suspend or reinstate this weightage, making it a critical, volatile metric that students must track leading up to the exam.

Telangana Fee Structures & Hidden Costs

Seats are bifurcated into Category A (Convenor Quota) and Category B (Management Quota). The TG ePASS system ensures that economically disadvantaged students securing a Category A seat receive significant, often complete, fee waivers. However, Category B seats possess deregulated fee structures, and the ePASS scheme explicitly excludes any student admitted under management quotas from fee reimbursement, leaving them entirely exposed to high private tuition costs.

The Single Most Common Mistake

A recurring and devastating failure point exists for religious and linguistic minority students (e.g., Muslim or Christian candidates). Many incorrectly assume that if they fail to qualify in the TG EAPCET, they are entirely locked out of engineering admissions. In reality, TSCHE administrative policy explicitly allows minority candidates who did not qualify—or even those who did not appear for the exam—to apply during a specific, narrow window for "left-over seats" in Minority Engineering and Pharmacy colleges⁶⁸. The mistake is missing this brief 4-day application window in June, thereby losing a legitimate opportunity for admission via the Convenor channel and being forced to pay management fees⁶⁸.

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